

Eleni Houvarda

Richmond, Virginia | 804-593-8726 | eleni.mariah04@gmail.com | LinkedIn

EDUCATION

B.S. in Computer Science, James Madison University (JMU)

Harrisonburg, VA

Cumulative GPA: 3.8

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages/Frameworks: Python, Java, C, JavaScript, TypeScript, PHP, HTML, React, Angular

Tools/Platforms: AWS, GitHub, Power BI, Dataiku, Playwright, Cucumber, Studio 5000 Logix, FactoryTalk

Methods: Scrum/Agile, automated testing, PLC/HMI systems, machine learning

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Automation Engineer

Jan 2026 - Present

Merck & Co. | Elkton, VA

- Implemented PLC logic and HMI systems using Studio 5000 Logix and FactoryTalk for industrial automation solutions.
- Analyzed operational datasets with Power BI and Dataiku to support a Lifecycle Management tool for site excellence initiatives.
- Created technical documentation and knowledge transfer materials (ROCKS) for systems owned by retiring subject matter experts.

Frontend Developer

May 2025 - Aug 2025

Ellucian | Reston, VA

- Built an AI-powered Journey add-on that generated skill maps from academic transcripts using software engineering practices.
- Integrated Claude AI to assess user soft skills and improve personalization in collaboration with AI developers.
- Designed React, JavaScript, and TypeScript features including a chatbot and onboarding page; partnered with back-end teams on cloud integration.

Computer Science Intern

Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

Richmond National Insurance | Richmond, VA

- Developed and maintained internal applications with Angular, JavaScript, and Java to meet business and technical requirements.
- Improved reliability by writing and running automated regression tests with Playwright and Cucumber.
- Researched SpaCy and Scikit-learn models for a spam email detection system supporting security initiatives.

PROJECT / LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Chair

Aug 2025 – Aug 2026

Alpha Omega Epsilon | Harrisonburg, VA

- Collaborated with campus organizations to host DEI events that promoted inclusivity and cultural awareness within the sorority.
- Tracked member DEI participation points and supported chapter engagement in diversity and inclusion initiatives.

Lead Teaching Assistant

Aug 2024 - Dec 2024

JMU Computer Science | Harrisonburg, VA

- Supervised a teaching assistant team and supported 100+ students in discrete mathematics and programming logic.
- Reported lab performance data to the Program Head and launched a discrete math review program with senior faculty.

Medical Software Research

Aug 2025 – Dec 2026

JMU Computer Science | Harrisonburg, VA

- Collaborate with Dr. Prajakta Belsare to analyze mealtime data in individuals with type 1 diabetes.
- Develop an application that collects user data and provides actionable feedback to help users manage blood sugar levels.

MERITS & CERTIFICATIONS

Academic Distinctions: President's List: Fall 2022, Dean's List: Spring 2023 - Spring 2026, Upsilon Pi Epsilon Honor Society (Computing and Information Disciplines), Magna Cum Laude Honors

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner, Pharmacy Technician Trainee

INTERESTS

Technology, Pharmacy, Medicine, Crocheting, Reading, Volunteering, Traveling, Alpha Omega Epsilon